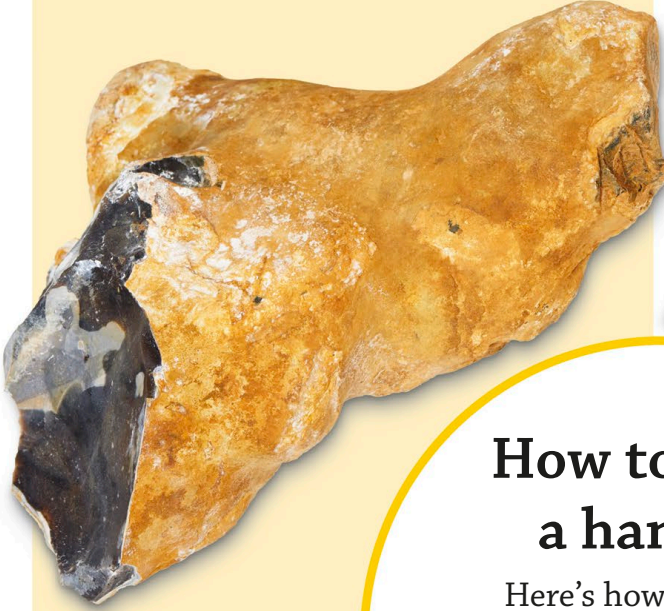


**1**

Toolmakers had to find the right type of rock. The rock here is flint, which is ideal. People would travel far to find the right stone for their tools.

**2**

They began by using large hammer stones to thin and shape the rock (called the core). By hitting both sides of the rock, large pieces were removed and the shape started to emerge.



## How to make a hand ax

Here's how Stone Age toolmakers shaped a hand ax from a piece of rock. They used stone, such as flint, which would break without crumbling when you struck it.

**4**

To thin it, the toolmaker hit the hand ax with either a smaller hard hammer, such as a pebble, or by using a soft hammer, such as a piece of deer antler.

**3**

The toolmakers continued to strike each side of the rock. Each strike created a flat "platform" on which to create the next strike.